MOUNTAINSIDE ASSOCIATION NEWSLETTER

March 1977

The Mountainside Association Board, elected by the membership in November, has organized itself for the year it will be in office. Lincoln Cathers was elected President; George Fiske, treasurer; Carol Green, secretary. Sam Ashelman continues as vice-president; Rol Capen continues as a member; and Randall Ashelman continues as advisor and counsel to the Board.

Most of the Committee Chairmen have been asked to continue this year: Roland Szadokierski as chairman of the Architectural Control Committee; Arthur Leech as head of Budget and Maintenance. Jim Washington has agreed to serve as Recreation Chief. Rol Capen will, of course, continue to head our committee supporting the Coolfont Foundation.

We are all diminished by the death of Alden Capen in December. His central influence on our lives was commemorated in a Treetop ceremony in which his friends in Morgan County, his relatives, and his admirers in the Coolfont community, reflected upon his role in our lives. We are indeed saddened.

The Board would like to ask everyone to examine the potential of the Barn to enrich our summer activities. There are lots of ideas. What plan has the greatest appeal? Please pass your thoughts on to Jim Washington.

Two points we might all consider as spring inevitably arrives. Householders should remember that Rol Capen will need help in housing the artists appearing in Foundation-sponsored programs: an opportunity to entertain delightful guests. And we are still looking for a new piano for the summer programs. Do you know anyone who would enjoy a tax break and has a medium-size grand piano?

Coolfont Development has taken the initial steps to build four additional tennis courts adjacent to The Barn, one of which will be a multi-purpose game area. The Board and a small group blessed the project on behalf of the Architectural Control Committee and the land was cleared and work undertaken. However, the winter freeze has blocked further work until the spring thaw.

Once again, the Board would like to point to the security problem. We have had no incidents. We don't want any. One possibility: report license tags on strange autos parked along our roads to Treetop. Strangers will be reminded that ours are private roads.

We are still looking for volunteers to serve on the Committees. If you have time and want to help, please drop a note to the Committee Chairmen noted above. Their addresses are:

Roland Szadokierski, 7207 Fort Hunt Rd., Alexandria, Va. 22307
Arthur Leech, Coolfont, Berkeley Springs, W. Va. 25411
Jim Washington, 1443 Holly Street NW, Washington, D. C. 20012
Rol Capen, Coolfont, Berkeley Springs, W. Va. 25411

In 1974 the membership approved the recommendations of a special task force for the administration of the recreation assessment. Succeeding Boards failed to follow through on this matter and have not since attempted to measure the size of the increased costs of lake and tennis court maintenance. The Board has now determined that these costs have averaged 10% per year. The recreation assessment will reflect an increase in the bills to members that will be distributed next October.

In February 1976 the Association Board established a policy relating to trash removal. Use of the, then new, B & M service required that trash cans be carried out to roadside for pickup. The result, in some cases, is that cans still remain by the side of the road for most of the week. It was stated as Board policy that members using this service should put their trash cans by the side of the road on the morning of the day of collection and remove them the same evening. The current Board reaffirms this rule.

This winter has been as difficult at Coolfont as it has elsewhere. House owners who use their houses infrequently might find it useful to look into ways and means to provide additional protection of their on-lot water lines, even though this "worst winter" may never recur.

Mary Weiss will undertake another day camp season this year. The pattern will be much the same though enlarged; will begin July 11 and continue until August 19. The programs for children, 6 - 14 years, will be from 9 - 4 daily, Monday through Friday.

At the Board meeting of February 26, Sam Ashelman outlined plans for a considerable augmentation of Coolfont as a Conference Center. The project is in two parts or phases. The far larger project, a 60-unit extension of Treetop itself, is Phase II. It is planned that this activity will be preceded by the erection of housing for about 20 conference attendees on Ashelman owned land directly across Cold Run Valley Road from Treetop. The Board walked to the site for the 20-unit building and examined the architectural drawings for both projects.

The tentative planning for the expansion of Coolfont to a full-fledged Conference Center has been going on a number of months, but the plans are not yet firm nor is a construction schedule set. Sam or Randy Ashelman will be delighted to show their ideas and plans to any interested Association member.

Two attachments: Changes in draft By-laws
Minutes of November Annual Meeting

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